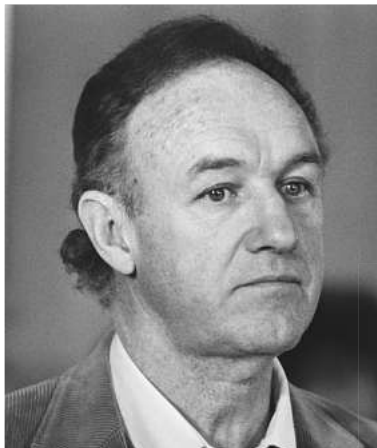


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MOHAMMAD ATTENDS HIGH-LEVEL MEETING CHAIRED BY HAMDAN

■ His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, yesterday attended a high-level meeting that brought together directors and senior officials from Dubai Government entities. Chaired by Shaikh Hamdan Bin Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Defence of the UAE, and Chairman of Dubai Executive Council, the meeting was held as part of 'Dubai Camp' activities. The initiative's aim was to shape a forward-thinking roadmap that ensures sustainable progress and prosperity for both present and future generations.

UAE road deaths in 2024 see a 9% increase

Young drivers most
at risk, distracted
driving top cause

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

Road accidents led to 384 fatalities last year, a 9 per cent increase from 2023, according to the Ministry of Interior's statistics on road safety for 2024.

Young people, aged between 19 and 29, were the most vulnerable, accounting for 40 per cent of fatalities and 42 per cent of injuries. A total of 383,086 new driving licences were issued last year, adding a significant number of vehicles to the roads in the country.

Overall, there were 6,062 people injured and 4,748 major accidents, both up by 8 per cent. Of the 384 deaths, Dubai had the highest number of fatalities

with 158, followed by Abu Dhabi (123) and Sharjah (32).

Among the fatalities, 223 (58 per cent) were in light vehicle crashes, and 67 (17 per cent) were in motorcycle accidents. Alarming, 98 per cent of these incidents occurred in good weather and clear road conditions. The top five violations were distracted driving, sudden deviation, tailgating, negligence, and lack of lane discipline.

SEE ALSO P3

UAE launches first domestic card scheme

JAYWAN IS NOW READY FOR USE
LOCALLY AND INTERNATIONALLY

ABU DHABI

BY JUSTIN VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

Al Etihad Payments (AEP), a subsidiary of the Central Bank of the UAE (CBUAE), has announced the launch of Jaywan, the country's first domestic card scheme.

With its launch, Jaywan joins a growing number of domestic card payment schemes that offer national payment infrastructure similar to what Mastercard and Visa offer internationally.

The system is now ready for use locally and internationally, WAM reported, supporting the UAE's efforts to expand digital payment options.

Australia's Eftpos, Brazil's Elo, India's RuPay, Saudi Arabia's Mada, Bahrain's Benefit, and Kuwait's KNET have gained popularity by having their own domestic systems to facilitate debit and credit card transactions. There are about 90 such schemes globally, with nearly 2 billion cards in circulation, representing less than 8 per cent of the 26 billion plastic cards in use today.

Jaywan aims to provide a secure and cost-effective payment option for individuals and busi-

90

domestic card
payment systems
in use globally

nesses. It is designed to lower transaction costs, speed up local payments using UAESWITCH, support e-commerce, while improving financial inclusion.

The scheme will offer different types of cards, including debit, prepaid, and credit cards, which can be used for online transactions, ATM withdrawals, and point-of-sale (POS) purchases. Customers can choose between:

■ A mono-badge card (Jaywan-only) for use in the UAE, GCC countries, and select international locations.

■ A co-badge card (Jaywan + international payment network) for broader global acceptance.

To expand usability, AEP has partnered with international payment networks such as Discover, Mastercard, Visa, and UnionPay. It has also signed an agreement with Samsung Gulf Electronics to enable Jaywan cards on Samsung Wallet.

FRIDAY/SPECIAL REPORT

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UAE's rising
business
leaders in focus**



NATION

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